

For those with a larger budget, the Nikon D90 is the most desirable DSLR around at Rs. 68,000. It's a great camera and it has a nice 18 – 105 mm lens. The lens' performance in terms of zoom is not at the same level as say a super zoom camera, but it's still a lot more than you find with other 18 – 55 mm stock lens. If you can afford it, the Canon EOS 5D is one of the best mid-range enthusiast DSLR to go for. The EOS 5D is priced a little more than the Nikon D90 just shy of Rs. 70,000. Those who are out looking for something a little smaller and a little simpler to use must take a look at the Olympus E-P1. It looks like a point and shoot camera but has some of the functionality of a DSLR. This also means that you can switch lenses. The price for the E-P1 is Rs. 43,995.



Olympus E-P1

There were also a bunch of teenagers who didn't have a large budget but wanted a digital camera for under Rs. 10,000. One of the things I liked was the screen and also its very colourful and compact interface. The price was around Rs. 8,000. If you really want Canon's natural colours, then the PowerShot A480 and the PowerShot A1100 are the models within this price range. Fujifilm also has a few models in that range and so does Nikon. I like Nikon's DSLRs as much as any other make but for cheaper point and shoots such as L19 and L20, I'm very hesitant in recommending them to anyone.

Having looked through some of these shops and having met customers, I wondered what I could find online. I went on to some online electronics shops and found the same models I saw in the shops. For one, DSLRs aren't as simple to buy online. The prices aren't very accurate either. They are cheaper than the mentioned MRP prices but definitely not the cheapest way to get cameras.

